LLM EVALUATION · REPRODUCIBILITY

I tried to reproduce my own AI finding. The model was gone — and the result flipped.

A reproducibility story about LLM-as-judge evaluation.

swipe →

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01 · JULY 2026

A clean-looking result.

Two Groq judges scored 36 Q&A pairs. Inter-judge agreement **collapsed** from κ 0.92 to 0.61 when I added subtle honesty items — and the **bigger** model (llama-70b) scored just **20%** on them vs the smaller model's 70%. It preferred confident fabrications over "I don't have that data."

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looked like a portable finding about model honesty

02 · OCTOBER 2026

Then I tried to reproduce it.

I re-ran the exact same gold set — same harness, same protocol, **temperature 0** — to cache the responses for offline replay.

Two surprises followed.

03 · SURPRISE #1

The headline model no longer exists.

LLAMA-3.3-70B-VERSATILE, EVERY CALL

404

Retired by Groq between the two runs. The original result is **not reproducible** — the model is gone.

04 · SURPRISE #2

With a new model pair, the finding reversed.

METRIC	JULY	OCTOBER
κ collapse?	0.92 → 0.61 **yes**	0.49 → 0.46 **no**
Bigger model, subtle acc.	20%	**80%**
Smaller model, subtle acc.	70%	50%

No collapse — and the honesty ranking **flipped**: the larger model was now the more honest one.

05 · WHAT SURVIVED BOTH RUNS

The durable lesson.

- Inter-judge agreement is not evidence of judge quality.
- Judge quality on hard items is model-specific — not predicted by size or a prior run.
- Eval findings have a shelf life.

06 · THE FIX

Findings rot. Infra is how you know.

The repo now ships a **record/replay cache**. Anyone can reproduce every number offline — no API key, no cost — so a result can't silently break when a model disappears.

```
uv run python -m eval.harness --replay
```

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the thing the July run lacked

TAKEAWAY

- A single eval run is a snapshot, not a law.
- Reproduce your own findings before you trust them.
- Build the infra that catches it when they break.

Follow for more on **evaluating AI honestly.**